

TRAFFIC ENGINEERING TEAM



BRIEFING NOTE

Subject	B3108 Winsley Speed Limit Reduction Request	Date:	April 2026
Circulation	David Thomas, Cllr Martin Smith		
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Ref	Notes	Action	
1	Introduction		
	This briefing note aims to outline and address the concerns raised by Winsley Parish Council and the elected Wiltshire Council representative for Winsley and Westwood division regarding vehicle speeds and pedestrian safety on the B3108 through the parish of Winsley. There has been a longstanding request to reduce the existing speed limits on the B3108 and as such a number of reviews undertaken by Wiltshire Council Highways department. Winsley Parish Council undertook a road safety survey of its residents and of 88 respondents, 59 stated that the speed limit on the B3108 is in their top 3 concerns regarding road safety in the parish. More information from the Parish Council survey and submission to LHFIG can be found in Appendix 1. It is this recent submission to LHFIG to which this briefing note responds.		
2	Previous action and reviews		
	Changes to signing and road markings were introduced at the Dane Rise and Tynning Road junctions through the Bradford on Avon Community Area Transport Group. These changes were introduced to improve visibility and awareness of the junctions to those travelling on the B3108. In addition, improvements were made to provide improved pedestrian access through dropped kerb and footway provision linking to the allotments at the Hartley junction. A previous in-house review of the speed limit along the B3108 including Winsley Hill, based on driven speed surveys and review against the guidance set out in the Department for Transport Circular 01/2013 'Setting Local Speeds Limits' was undertaken in early 2020. This did not recommend any speed limit changes. A review undertaken in 2022 relating to the B3108 between its junctions with Winsley Road and Limpley Stoke Road concluded that whilst the criteria for a speed limit reduction to 40mph was not met, engineering measures to safely manage pedestrian movements from Dane Rise toward Hartley Farm would be appropriate. Subsequently, a traffic signal-controlled crossing is due to be installed in Summer 2026 (see Appendix 2 for plan).		

3	Parish Council / Local Concerns	
	The concerns raised locally regarding the B3108 are summarised below: • Danger to pedestrians crossing the B3108, in particular risks to children, elderly residents, wheelchair users, cyclists, and dog walkers • Vehicles regularly exceeding the existing speed limits • The frequency and severity of collisions and frequent near misses • Increased pedestrian activity across the B3108 due to growth of businesses at Hartley Farm, the expansion of the Bradford on Avon Rugby Club and Avonpark retirement village The following locations were highlighted as particular areas of concern along the B3108. The issues raised related to poor visibility when exiting these junctions, conflicting vehicle movements when turning and frequent pedestrian movements. • Hartley Farm junction • Dane Rise junction • Tynning Road junction • Murhill junction • Access to the Rugby Club / Ashley Lane junction • Winsley Hill There is overall support for the forthcoming signal-controlled crossing to be installed near the Dane Rise junction, however there is an overarching concern that operation within a 50mph speed limit will reduce the safety of the crossing. It was also noted that the recent temporary speed limit reduction (introduced as part of Highways England works on the A36) to 40mph between Winsley Road and Limpley Stoke Road and to 30mph on Winsley Hill was welcomed by the local community with reports that this resulted in reduced noise, smoother traffic flow and improved safety.	
4	Collision Data	
	A review of collision data provided by Wiltshire Police between 1st January 2022 and 19th March 2026 has been undertaken. During this time period, there were 6 recorded personal injury collisions; the locations of which can be seen overleaf.	



Of these collisions, four were classified as 'slight', one classified as 'serious' and one classified as 'very serious'. A summary of the collisions is in the below table.

Classification	Description	Probable causation
Slight	Single vehicle loss of control	Slippery road (due to weather) Too fast for conditions
Serious	Turning vehicle collision with overtaking motorcycle	Poor manoeuvre (both vehicles) Failed to look (both vehicles) Failed to signal/misleading signal Following too close Failed to judge other persons path/speed
Slight	Rear end shunt	Driving too fast for conditions Failed to look Sudden braking Road layout Failed to judge others path/speed
Slight	Motorcycle crossed in to opposing lane colliding with oncoming vehicle	Vehicle (motorcycle) in course of a crime Stolen vehicle Inexperienced rider Loss of control
Slight	Single vehicle loss of control	Impaired by alcohol Impaired by drugs Careless/Reckless/In a hurry Exceeding speed limit
Very Serious	Cyclist struck by car exiting driveway	Ineffective observation (both) Obscured view due to layout Too fast for conditions (cycle)

Exceeding the speed limit is highlighted as a contributory factor to one of the above collisions. 'Too fast for conditions' is highlighted as a factor in three of these collisions.

5	Traffic Data																																																													
	Connected vehicle data has been used to identify driven speeds on the B3108 in 2024, 2025 (whilst the temporary speed limits were in place) and in 2026. Connected vehicle speed data is generally very reliable and offers an accurate and timely way to understand traffic conditions, often more effectively than traditional roadside equipment alone. Modern vehicles measure their speed accurately using built-in sensors and GPS. When speed information from many vehicles is combined, it provides a clear and dependable picture of how fast traffic is moving on different roads and at different times. Any small errors from individual vehicles are evened out when the data is averaged, making the overall results robust. The following tables show speed data at three points on the B3108. During the 2025 period, a temporary 40mph speed limit was in operation with a temporary 30mph speed limit in operation on Winsley Hill. <table> <tr> <th colspan="3">B3108 – west of Dane Rise junction</th></tr> <tr> <th colspan="3">Westbound</th></tr> <tr> <th>Date Range</th><th>Average speed</th><th>85th percentile speed</th></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2024</td><td>36.60mph</td><td>43.5mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2025</td><td>34.18mph</td><td>40.39mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2026</td><td>34.38mph</td><td>42.25mph</td></tr> <tr> <th colspan="3">Eastbound</th></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2024</td><td>37.29mph</td><td>43.50mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2025</td><td>29.12mph</td><td>41.63mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2026</td><td>36.47mph</td><td>44.12mph</td></tr> </table> <table> <tr> <th colspan="3">B3108 – west of Ashley Lane junction</th></tr> <tr> <th colspan="3">Westbound</th></tr> <tr> <th>Date Range</th><th>Average speed</th><th>85th percentile speed</th></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2024</td><td>38.38mph</td><td>44.12mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2025</td><td>24.17mph</td><td>41.01mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2026</td><td>38.00mph</td><td>44.74mph</td></tr> <tr> <th colspan="3">Eastbound</th></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2024</td><td>41.32mph</td><td>47.22mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2025</td><td>29.9mph</td><td>42.5mph</td></tr> <tr> <td>1st January to 1st March 2026</td><td>40.69mph</td><td>46.60mph</td></tr> </table>	B3108 – west of Dane Rise junction			Westbound			Date Range	Average speed	85th percentile speed	1 st January to 1 st March 2024	36.60mph	43.5mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2025	34.18mph	40.39mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2026	34.38mph	42.25mph	Eastbound			1 st January to 1 st March 2024	37.29mph	43.50mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2025	29.12mph	41.63mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2026	36.47mph	44.12mph	B3108 – west of Ashley Lane junction			Westbound			Date Range	Average speed	85th percentile speed	1 st January to 1 st March 2024	38.38mph	44.12mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2025	24.17mph	41.01mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2026	38.00mph	44.74mph	Eastbound			1 st January to 1 st March 2024	41.32mph	47.22mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2025	29.9mph	42.5mph	1 st January to 1 st March 2026	40.69mph	46.60mph	
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B3108 – west of Murhill		
Eastbound		
Date Range	Average speed	85 th percentile speed
1 st January to 1 st March 2024	28.48mph	36.66mph
1 st January to 1 st March 2025	22.94mph	34.80mph
1 st January to 1 st March 2026	30.72mph	37.28mph
Westbound		
1 st January to 1 st March 2024	31.08mph	36.66mph
1 st January to 1 st March 2025	19.95mph	34.8mph
1 st January to 1 st March 2026	32.23mph	37.28mph

The recorded average speeds in 2025 whilst the temporary speed limits were in operation at all three locations show a reduction when compared to the same time periods in 2024 and 2026. When looking at average speed alone, this suggests that the reduced speed limit was effective in managing vehicle speeds however when looking at also at the recorded 85% percentile speeds, it can be seen that there is a significant difference between those average and 85th percentile speeds in the 2025 data.

A large difference between the average speed and the 85th percentile speed usually means that traffic speeds are widely spread rather than consistent. In simple terms, some drivers are travelling much faster than others.

What this typically indicates:

- **Uneven driving behaviour:** Many vehicles are travelling at moderate or low speeds, while a smaller group is driving significantly faster.
- **Possible congestion or friction:** Slower speeds may be caused by junctions, parking, pedestrian activity, road condition, or turning movements, while faster drivers take advantage of gaps.
- **Speed compliance issues:** A high 85th percentile compared with the average can suggest that a notable proportion of drivers are exceeding the intended or posted speed.
- **Increased safety risk:** Large speed differences between vehicles are linked to higher collision risk, because they increase overtaking, braking, and conflict between road users.

By contrast, when average speed and 85th percentile speed are closer together, as they are in the 2024 and 2026 data, it usually indicates more uniform traffic flow, which is generally safer and easier to manage. The data also shows good compliance with the permanent posted speed limits of 50mph and 40mph respectively.

6	Development / Planning Approvals	
	Hartley Farm is a key attractor of both pedestrian and vehicular traffic within the Winsley parish. The development and expansion of the farm shop alongside other commercial premises within the site draw in custom from the village and further afield. A 70 place children's day nursery opened on the site in 2025 adding further pedestrian and vehicle movements into and out of Hartley Lane. As the development of Hartley Farm has been piecemeal, there have been no significant planning requirements for highway improvements imposed as part of any planning consent. Bradford on Avon Rugby Club is also sited adjacent to the B3108, accessed from Ashley Lane. The club have recently been granted permission for expansion. A traffic assessment was submitted and considered as part of the planning process, which concluded that the expansion proposals would not offer a material impact on traffic flow and as such off-site highway works were not required. The Avonpark Retirement Village is also subject to redevelopment and has been through the planning process. As part of this, a Section 278 agreement is in place for highway improvements to be undertaken by the developer. This is to improve the bus stop facilities on the B3108 near the Avonpark access and incorporate an informal pedestrian crossing point.	
7	Department for Transport 01/13 Setting Local Speed Limits	
	It is set out in 01/13 that <i>'Drivers are likely to expect and respect lower limits, and be influenced when deciding on what is an appropriate speed, where they can see there are potential hazards, for example outside schools, in residential areas or villages and in shopping streets.'</i> The DfT state that therefore a principal aim for determining appropriate speed limits should be to provide a consistent message between the speed limit and what the road looks like and for changes in speed limit to be reflective of changes in the road layout and character. The following are important factors when considering what is an appropriate speed limit. • history of collisions, including frequency, severity, types and causes • road geometry and engineering (width, sightlines, bends, junctions, accesses and safety barriers and so on) • road function (strategic, through traffic, local access et cetera) • composition of road users (including existing and potential levels of vulnerable road users); • existing traffic speeds • road environment, including level of road-side development and possible impacts on residents (e.g. severance, noise, or air quality) It is recognised within the circular that different road users perceive risks and appropriate speeds differently, with drivers often not having the same perception of the hazards of speeds as people on foot, cycles or horseback. The needs of vulnerable road users must be taken into account. The guidance does however also state <i>'Speed limits should not be used to attempt to solve the problem of isolated hazards, for example a single road junction or reduced forward visibility such as at a bend, since speed limits are difficult to enforce over such a short length. Other measures, such as warning signs including vehicle activated signs, carriageway markings, junction improvements, superelevation of bends and new or improved street lighting, are likely to be more effective in addressing such hazards. Similarly, crossings or, in rural areas, the</i>	

provision of adequate footways can be a more effective means of improving pedestrian safety than lowering a speed limit over a short distance.'

It may be that a speed limit need not be changed if the collision rate can be improved or wider quality of life objectives can be achieved through other speed management measures, or other measures. These alternative measures should always be considered before proceeding with a new speed limit.

The following table sets out the speed limits for single carriageway roads in rural locations as would be applicable to the B3108.

Speed limit (mph)	Where limit should apply:
60	Recommended for most high quality strategic A and B roads with few bends, junctions or accesses.
50	Should be considered for lower quality A and B roads that may have a relatively high number of bends, junctions or accesses. Can also be considered where mean speeds are below 50 mph, so lower limit does not interfere with traffic flow.
40	Should be considered where there are many bends, junctions or accesses, substantial development, a strong environmental or landscape reason, or where there are considerable numbers of vulnerable road users.

B3108 – Winsley Road to Limpley Stoke Road

This section sets out how the criteria above relates to this part of the B3108 in terms of characteristics.

The B3108 forms part of the A and B class road network and is classed as '3A – Main Distributor' in the hierarchy of road function. This means that the function of the road is as part of the strategic network, providing an inter-urban link.

Whilst the B3108 bounds the village of Winsley, there is not substantial development alongside the carriageway and no properties front directly onto the B3108. Junctions and accesses, of which there are relatively few, are visible to approaching drivers, with junction warning signs and road markings provided to highlight the main junctions on the route.

Pedestrian movements, along with other vulnerable road users, do take place along and across the B3108. There is a footway adjacent to the south side of the carriageway to accommodate this. There are regular crossing movements between the village and areas to north, particularly linking to Hartley Farm. It is recognised that these movements are regular, however in terms of volume they would not be classed as 'considerable'. The signal-controlled crossing due to be installed later this year will accommodate safe pedestrian movements around the Dane Rise/Hartley Lane junction.

The collision history for the study area does not identify a significant cluster of collisions resulting in personal injury. Local anecdotal data suggests there have been numerous damage-only collisions involving vehicles making turning movements into Dane Rise and Tynning Road. The provision of the crossing may assist with these turning movements at busier times by creating gaps in traffic flow.

The carriageway width is consistent and suitable for the type and volume of vehicular traffic.

	<u>B3108 Winsley Hill</u> To consider a 30mph speed limit, the area must meet the definition of a village as set out in the Department for Transport's TAL 01/04 which sets out that reasonable minimum criteria for the definition of what constitutes a village, for the purpose of applying a village speed limit of 30mph, would be that there were both: • 20 or more houses (frontage development on one or both sides of the road) • a minimum length of 600m The speed limit reduction has been requested over a distance greater than 600m. The distance from the existing speed limit terminal point close the junction with Murhill and the access to 4 Lower Stoke is approximately 980m. In terms of properties alongside the road through this section, there are fifteen that may be considered to be fronting on to the B3108 although a number of these are set back behind walls or hedges and so visibility from the road is limited. The remaining properties are set further back away from the B3108 and not visible to passing motorists. This level of frontage development over the distance of 980m does not meet the definition of a village as set out in TAL01/04. Through Winsley Hill, there are many accesses to properties which enter/exit directly onto the B3108, even where the properties are considerably set back and not visible. There are a number of bends and a considerable gradient between the Canal Bridge and Murhill.	
8	Conclusion	
	<u>B3108 Winsley Road to Limpley Stoke Road</u> Taking into consideration the data collected, site observations and assessment against DfT criteria, a case cannot be made to support the introduction of a 40mph speed limit. The average speeds are relatively low and whilst a further reduction in average speed was seen during the implementation of a temporary 40mph speed limit, the variation between the average and 85th percentile speeds during this time demonstrate a lack of compliance with the limit from drivers. With the current speed limit, these two measurements are within a closer range which demonstrates that drivers are tending to drive at similar speeds as the speed limit is well understood through the visual cues of the location and not just from the signing denoting the limit. Lack of compliance with a speed limit and broad differences between average speed and 85th percentile speeds can create a situation where some drivers are more likely to carry out risky manoeuvres and where judging driver behaviour and speed is more difficult for vulnerable road users or those entering/exiting junctions. It is recommended that the 50mph speed limit be retained. The traffic signal crossing due to be installed near Dane Rise will be a key benefit to pedestrian and will safely accommodate many of the pedestrian movements across the B3108. It is recognised that concerns may remain regarding crossing to access the Rugby Club and as such it may be appropriate for engineering measures to improve the crossing facility in this area to be investigated. This may be considered through the Highway Improvement Request process.	

	The S278 works being taken forward at the Avonpark development will offer some improvement over the current situation. <u>B3108 Winsley Hill</u> The criteria set out in TAL 01/04 and Circular 01/13 relating to the setting of 30mph speed limits in rural areas is not met in this case. This section of the B3108 does however strongly demonstrate the criteria set out for a 40mph speed limit, which is currently in place. The speed data collected shows a very good compliance with the existing speed limit with the majority of drivers travelling below the 40mph speed limit. However, during the implementation of the temporary 30mph limit, the average speed reduced but the difference between average and 85th percentile speeds was significant indicating a lack of compliance.	
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